Backbones and No Backbones · Staff Answers

Learning goal: I can find a backbone on a diagram and sort animals with and without a backbone.

Arrival Answers

1. Box 1 shows a bone row.
2. Yes. A fish has a backbone.
3. It is on the outside.
4. Yes. You can ask or pass.

Starter & Hinge Answers

Starter: A. A crab has a hard case on the outside and no backbone inside.

Hinge: A. A line of small bones down the back proves it has a backbone.

Evidence Desk Cards

Fish x-ray: Has a backbone: the bone row is clear.

Crab diagram: No backbone: its hard case is on the outside.

Earthworm clue: No backbone: a soft body has no spine.

Frog skeleton: Has a backbone: it has a spine inside.

Snail card: No backbone: its shell is on the outside.

Mystery shadow: Not enough evidence: we need an inside clue.

Check & Repair Answer

Legs do not prove a backbone. A fish has a row of

bones inside.

Exit Ticket Answers

1. Cat. 2. A fish or cat has a row of bones down its back. 3. A hard outside shell or a soft fluid-filled body.